

Background Survey MS&E152

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Current run (last updated Jul 6, 2026 1:16pm)

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Activities

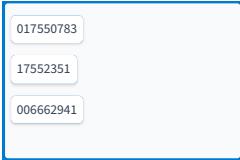
44

Participants

41

Average responses

SUNET ID (number)



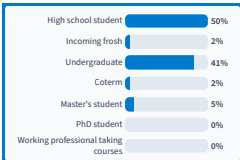
Responses

017549620	06510002	017562481	idjsbb	06930752	017549954	
17549667	06742684	kea09ns	kae09ns	c1ndyu	17549557	17550106
17550106	17552334	017549807	1754916	leograef	leograef	017551888
17549503	17561421	017552300	kjt04	17552351	17549739	017598545
017549477	017552300	017549944	017549580	017552986	17553611	
ed8434wn	a0333113	colt2209	006992703	17549971	17552612	
17581201	17550024	017550783	17552351	006662941		

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Responses

What is your academic status?



Response options

High school student

Incoming frosh

Undergraduate

Coterm

Master's student

PhD student

Working professional taking courses

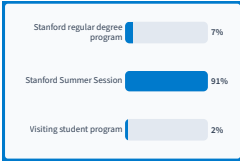
Count Percentage

22	50%
1	2%
18	41%
1	2%
2	5%
0	0%
0	0%

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Responses

Are you enrolled through:



Response options

Stanford regular degree program

Stanford Summer Session

Visiting student program

Count Percentage

3	7%
39	91%
1	2%

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Responses

What is your major, intended major, or primary field of study?

Ms&E

Physics

Responses

Not entirely sure but something math related maybe

Psychology, Learning Design and Technology

finance

business and economics

Finance

Finance, business, econ

Business Economics

Economics

Tech engineering and finance

Management Science and Engineering

Product design/Material science/Urban studies/Chemical oceanography/Music engineering

My intended major is decision science and psychology, I might take economics as my double major.

major in Business

Potentially MS&E

Business Administration, Computer Science

I hope to major in data science or something that incorporates statistics and engineering.

computer science or economics

Business management and entrepreneurship

Computer Science Major

not completely sure, deciding between econ, psych, sports management, or poli-sci

International Management

As a result of being in high school, my major is not entirely determined. However, I intend to study business: Specifically marketing and entrepreneurship.

chemical engineering

Physics

Ethics in Society, Economics

Civil Engineering.

My intended major is business or something regarding marketing

Intended major is in business: Specifically, marketing and entrepreneurship

My intended major is Business Analytics, leading into a master's degree of Sports Analytics/Sports Management.

Business

Engineering/Applied physics

product design

Engineering

Industrial & System Engineering

Engineering

Poli Sci/ Law

Mechanical Engineering

MS&E

B.S. Psychology

economic

Philosophy, politics and economics

Ms&E

Physics

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Responses

What is the most recent mathematics, statistics, or probability course you have completed? Please include the course number and institution if applicable.

Responses

Intro to Calculus (Calculus A equivalent) at Russian School of Math

Stanford, 2021 PSYCH10

AP statistics & AP calculus AB

Calc 1

Statistical Theory and Methods I STAT 24400 (UChicago)

Pre Calculus

Financial mathematics in Audencia (France) about 3 month ago

MS&E 125 - Introduction to Applied Statistics (Stanford)

Emma Willard School, Precalculus with Non-Routine problems: The course covers sinusoidal functions, analytical trigonometry, conics, probability and counting problems, introduction to statistics, sequences and series, more in-depth study of rational and polynomial functions, optimization problems, and an introduction to limits.

Emma Willard School, Precalculus with Non-Routine problems

I've finished the AP Calculus BC course in my current high school in Guangzhou, China (The Affiliated High School of South China Normal University). I also take a statistics course in Stanford Summer Session (STATS 110: Introduction to Statistics for the Engineering and the Sciences).

AP stats

AP calculus BC

In Norway I had maths where I did probability and statistics for roughly 6 months, but this was a little over a year ago so I will be revising to make sure I can do all coursework.

I have completed AP Statistics and AP Calculus BC at Arapahoe High School.

High school Honors Precalculus

Quantitative methods at Maastricht university

I completed Pre-Calculus at Glenbrook South High School

Walt Whitman High School (Bethesda, MD) Honors Pre-Calculus

Quantitative Methods II at ESB Business School

AP Calculus AB

NA

University of Exeter - PHY2025

algebra 2, and euclidean and analytic geometry (castilleja school)

Differential Equations and Linear Algebra, New York University, Tandon School of Engineering.

AP Calculus AB

This past year in High School (I attended Notre Dame Academy, Worcester MA), I completed Statistics Advanced Honors (extremely similar to the material in Advanced Placement Statistics). I also completed Advanced Honors Pre-Calculus.

AP Calculus BC at TWCPHS

UW Pre-Calculus

Intro to probability and statistics at university of Iceland

Statistics through Century College MATH 1025-01

Calculus II through Metropolitan State University- MATH 211-01

<https://courses.newschool.edu/courses/LMTH1950/>

Parsons School of Design

MA1508 Linear Algebra ; IE2111 System Thinking (National University of Singapore NUS)

High School Stats (non-AP)

Ap stats

Ap calc bc

ID myp math class in G10 class before the summer

statistics course in my university (Fauldade Sirio Libanes, Brazil)

I took a statistics course 10 years ago from imam abdulrahman bin faisal university

Exeter University- PHY2025

Quantitative economics at University of Oxford

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Responses

How comfortable are you with probability and statistics?

Response options	Count	Percentage
No prior experience	5	12%
Basic familiarity	14	33%
Completed one introductory course	18	42%
Completed multiple courses	6	14%
Advanced background	0	0%

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Responses

Does this course fulfill a requirement for your degree or program? (e.g., Ways of Thinking/Ways of Doing, major requirement, elective, etc.)

Response options	Count	Percentage
Yes	18	43%
No	24	57%

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Responses

Why are you taking this course?

Responses

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Responses

I want to explore probability more, as it's not something that we do in depth in our school math curriculum.

gain a deeper understanding of decision analysis and applying to business

I thought the course description looked interesting, and I wanted a more logic/engineering-based course in my schedule at summer session so I could experience a wide variety of types of classes. I had a little bit of prior experience with statistics and enjoyed it, and I'm looking to expand on those skills and more.

I think this class will be helpful for writing recommendation reports.

I am taking this course because I am interested to learn about how I can make better decisions in not only engineering but also life and I want to see if this course is capable of answering this question for me. I also want to learn about the behavior of other individuals and how it can be explained. I also have an interest in taking this course further in the future so it holds some more importance to as why I picked the course in that aspect.

I have always been interested in personal planning and decision making, wanting to think about best outcomes when it comes to a singular decision. I was inspired to take this course because of the way people are able to mathematically (maybe?) calculate the probability and statistics of things happening, or decisions being made.

Because I am genuinely interested in how to make decisions and how this field of study is related to closest to my interests industries

To improve my mathematical and analytical skills

Personal Interest

My goal is to create a well-run company in a few months, so in order to achieve that I need to learn how to make good decisions.

I was curious about the branch of decision analysis since it is completely new to me. Also it doubles as completing a major requirement for my MS&E major.

When I was learning microeconomics, I found Behavioral Econ very intriguing to me, especially the topics about how those economists and "rational decision makers"(unsure if it's the right term) decide what to do based on different incentives. I am also doing research on consumer responses and how they behave when they are nudged by different medias such as ads, propagandas, and even labels on products.

I take this course because it aligns closely with my majors in decision science, behavioral economics and psychology. The quantitative, probability-based decision frameworks it teaches will directly support my ongoing research paper on self-nudging and cognitive biases. I also want to learn structured tools like influence diagrams to frame uncertain real-world problems, quantify risk preferences, and evaluate decision quality. Beyond technical skills, I am eager to explore the limits of rationality and ethical considerations in human choice, which are essential to my academic study of behavioral judgment. In addition, I find out that there are philosophy ideas (emotional) under these rational disciplines, which is super fun.

I make important decision

i am curious about how to make decisions because i usually taking alot time to consider my decision and regret about it.

I am taking Introduction to Decision Analysis because I appreciate and am fascinated by the ways in which mathematical and objective ways of thinking can be applied to circumstances which are often navigated with emotion and subjective reasoning. One of my primary passions is math and therefore I love to learn how math can be applied to fields/areas which we would often assume it couldn't be (or is too complicated to do so). I also want to potentially explore a career as an actuary, so I thought this class could be helpful in developing sound decision-making skills in finance and the business world.

I believe it will help in the fields and careers I am thinking about pursuing, especially economics and math.

Because i want to know the reasoning behind decisions, so that i can adapt myself better to possible outcomes

I am interested in learning about decision-making and its role in the advancing digital world.

I've always been a very indecisive person, so being able to analyze my decisions and the different choices I have would be helpful in my daily life. I also want to take a statistics class at school, so this class would also give me a lot of good background information for that as well.

General interest, I hope it will be useful for my future career

Responses

I am taking this course as I am very curious about the process of making a decision. On top of this, I feel that learning how to properly make decisions and the science behind them will help me improve both in my personal life as well as my professional life.

I am taking this course because I want to learn more about the process of decision making, and how to better make decisions. My overall hope is to be able to use the tools and processes taught in this course as a resource to help make more informed decisions in areas of business, ethics, and education.

Personal Interest

General interest

I am taking this course as a result of my curiosity regarding the process in which decisions should be made. Looking forward, I want to utilize what I learn in both my day to day decision making as well as in professional decisions I will need to make.

I am very interested in both psychology and statistics. I am very passionate about exploring the two and how they can coexist together in all types of situations. I am truly excited to explore both the mental and mathematical size of decision-making, tying back to my want to study business analytics in college.

I want to take a MS&E course so that I can get a feel for the major, this specific course caught my eye as I am interested in decision making and statistics

I find an interest in Decision analysis and think it can have applications in many fields

I am interested in starting my own company in the future and wanted to learn more about risks and how making choices affects the path I will take in the future

I am taking this course with the goal of determining if this is an area of engineering I wish to pursue throughout my career.

wanted to learn how i can justify my decisions

The pure fascination of probabilities and decision making allured me to enrol in this course

Complement the knowledge and field of study from my Engineering major .

I'm taking this course because it sounded interesting

The course material seems professionally useful and also appears to me tangentially related to my philosophical study

I'm interested in math and stats

I think it will help with learning economics

Degree requirement

To complement my curriculum and career

I have a keen interest in the process of making decisions and on a personal level, would like to make good ones

General interest

What are you hoping to get out of this course? (Skills, topics, applications, or experiences you would especially like to gain.)

Responses

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Responses

Knowledge on how to apply probability in different circumstances

applying skillset to business contexts

I would like to learn more about the process of decision making and analysis, and expand skills related to statistics, math, etc. I also just hope to gain the experience of what it's like to take a course at a college.

The ability to justify and make compelling my thought processes and decisions, primarily in written form.

I might have previously explained some of the reasons but I also think that I could help to apply these lessons I learn in this course to some of my life and to help me re-assess choices I have made in the past and why they were made. In addition I want to learn how I can become an engineer who can consistently think critically and help make better impact through this gained understanding. It would also be useful for me to revise some the units such as probability as I have not done it in a little over a year and will have it as a unit in math next year.

I hope to be able to apply decision analysis in my everyday life, whether it be a small decision or life altering. Being able to solve problems or formulate answers to certain decisions would also be a skill that I hope to practice in this course.

Critical thinking, link mixed themes and fast+rational decision making

Advance in stats, making optimal decisions

I hope to build a robust framework for decision-making, discuss ideas with people coming from a wide range of backgrounds, and actively listen to professional suggestions from people in this field!

I hope to build a robust framework for decision-making, discuss ideas with people, actively listen to a wide range of ideas and professional suggestions from the people in this field!

To know what I am interested to major in.

A format with the steps to make a probably good decision, which decisions should be taken fast, which one slow.

I'm hoping to not only gain a theoretical understanding of decision analysis but to also gain a deep understanding of decision modeling through the group project.

I hope to master quantitative decision tools such as influence diagrams and probability value modeling to quantify risk and subjective uncertainty. I also want to learn how to properly frame complex decision problems and evaluate decision quality with real-world cases from finance and behavioral research. These practical skills will greatly help my research on self-nudging and cognitive biases. Additionally, I hope to deepen my understanding of bounded rationality and decision ethics, and gain hands-on problem-solving experience through class projects.(Looking forward for intensive discussions!)

I am hoping to learn concepts that will help me in everyday life as well as possible career paths. I'm excited to learn how the course material can apply to real-world problems in economics and business.

Method to measure the effectiveness of decision making, learn how to be a good decision maker

Know the outcomes of each kind of decision made

I hope to learn how to apply probability to complicated, real-life situations which involve deeper critical thinking beyond, for example, the flip of a coin. As previously stated, I also hope that this course will inform me on relevant subjects related to actuarial science. Along with this, I believe the course will serve me well in developing my general decision-making skills so that I can grow to be successful and accomplished.

Being able to anticipate decisions

I want to learn how to make better structured decisions when outcomes are uncertain. I hope to gain simple tools that help with complex choices and understand how decision making works in a fast changing digital world.

Similar to the last question, I want to make better decisions without being too indecisive or impulsively doing things.

hopefully being able to apply those skills on hiring decisions in the future

being able to make smart decisions

Responses

Upon completion of this course, I would like to be able to manage risk and reward more efficiently and effectively. All in all, I want to learn more about this topic and leave this class with new ideas and a new way of approaching problems.

I am hoping to learn more about how ethics plays a role in decision making, and how to apply the tools and processes learned to the areas of equal education and businesses and leadership.

Skills that are transferrable to my degree (chemical engineering) and also outside of my degree like for work and personal life.

Skills, application and just general experience.

I would say more technique using spreadsheets. I have basic knowlegde about spreadsheets, but I would love to become more experienced in spreahsheet work.

A better understanding of how to apply decision making principles and a feel for MS&E

The ability to make good decisions that result in good outcomes no matter what i pursue

I struggled making the decision to come to Stanford as a summer session student, so when I finally made that choice I thought I had to learn to do it properly.

I am hoping to learn decision making skills that can impact what college, area of study, and other decisions involving my future.

Harnessing decision optimising skill sets and layering a better groundwork for probabilities subject.

I am hoping to build my knowledge on decision making, as I believe it will help me throughout life.

I'm hoping to gain some decision making skills and to integrate the concepts I learn with my ethics

Decision analysis is a topic I've never really looked into before, and I hope this course will give me a comprehensive understanding of this topic

The ability to make good and clear choices

Knowledge

Quantitative and rational skills for complex decision making

A rigorous process/matrix to make and analyse decisions

Is there anything else you'd like the instructional staff to know about your background or goals? (Optional)

Responses

N/A n/a N/a If I did I would come to the office hours to discuss about it

I hope to be able to learn in a way so I can better absorb information, so when I fiddle around or doodle, please know that I am paying attention and listening fully.

I am excited and ready to learn I am very interested in probability and how it is applied.

Only that my goal is to create a company N/A

I've dealt with indecision my entire life. It is extremely hard for me to settle on a choice; after I make any decision, I keep doubting whether it was the best possible one and constantly worry about undesirable outcomes. This internal struggle drives my strong interest in this course. I'm so excited to learn standardized, data-backed decision tools to judge options objectively.

Not really but I like reading a lot and I read thinking fast and slow by Kahnemann

No, thanks. n/a

My primary goals with this course are to learn about the topic, be able to apply it in my day to day life, and to meet new people with similar interests as me and unique perspectives.

While I am not very experienced in statistics or probability, I would love to be able to gain a decent understanding of the basics to support my progress throughout this course. If there are any resources or things you recommend I do to familiarize myself with this topic to aid my success in this course, please let me know as I would love to learn more.

NIL N/A

My overall goal is to learn the material and be able to apply it in my day to day life.

My goal is to have a better understanding of decision making by the end of this course. I am very excited to be a part of this course, and look forward to learning new material throughout the class periods!

I am a football player at Stanford (long snapper) and in the Marine Corps reserves (why my head is shaved)

I'm fine.

I'm worried that I'm not a fit to the class, it would be helpful if I can see the homeworks and content early on to drop early if needed

N/A I don't have a lot of quantitative and probability skills.

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Responses